

To create an alert:

1. Type in the search terms on which you wish to base your search results. This can either be a simple string of keywords, or you can create an advanced search term using the various operators discussed in Chapter 7, or via the Advanced search page. It is a good idea to run a trial search with your search term to see how the results look. If you are satisfied with the results, you can then copy the search term into the “search terms” box.
2. Select what type of search it is, based on the five possible variants
3. Select at what frequency you want to be alerted—once a day, as-it-happens, or once a week. Determining the alert frequency will depend on the search topic. Fast moving topics should generally be set to once a week, or you will be drowning in alerts! For slow-moving topics like a specific scientific or medical breakthrough, an as-it-happens alert will be better.
4. Click on “Create Alert” to finish.

Once the alert is created, you can sit back and wait to be updated according to the specified frequency. The Edit and Delete next to each alert link enables you to edit the alert—changing the search terms, the type and frequency, and deleting the alert when it is no longer relevant. You can also specify whether the alert should be in HTML or plain text.